

Gun Was Teacher's

By DEAN POLING

Times Staff Writer

A gun found beside the body of a Pine Grove Primary School fourth-grade teacher shot to death sometime late Sunday or early Monday belonged to the teacher, authorities said Wednesday.

Investigators are unsure how to rule the shooting death because of minor injuries found on Beverly K. Schappaugh's body.

An autopsy report released late Tuesday from the Georgia State Crime Lab in Atlanta said Ms. Schappaugh, 48, of Valdosta, died of internal bleeding resulting from a single gunshot wound to her left breast area.

The gun causing the wound belonged to her, said Detective Capt. Billy W. Selph of the Lowndes County Sheriff's Department.

When officials found Ms. Schappaugh dead at 6:45 a.m. Monday in her gray 1987 Nissan Sentra, a .38-caliber handgun was lying in the passenger seat beside her, sheriff's reports said. The car was parked in the eastern corner of Pine Grove Primary's playground on Bemiss Road, the school where she taught and worked for the past year.

After the death was reported Monday by a man walking his dog, Selph said, investigators noticed Ms. Schappaugh had several minor injuries resembling bruises. Early autopsy reports by Dr. Gerald Gowitt at the Atlanta crime lab confirmed minor injuries, he said.

Selph would not specify the location of Ms. Schappaugh's minor injuries, but said several more tests are being done at both the Atlanta and Moultrie state crime labs.

Anyone with any information is asked to call the sheriff's department at 333-5138.

Ms. Schappaugh is believed to have been working at the school Sunday afternoon. Pine Grove Primary Principal Bernard Perry said it is not uncommon for teachers to work on Sundays, especially Ms. Schappaugh.

"She was a very dedicated teacher who was enjoyed by her students, their parents and her fellow teachers," he said. "Instead of going strictly by the books or curriculum, she had a different approach to teaching to get her students more involved."

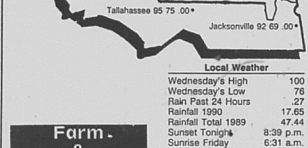
Perry cited as an example when Ms. Schappaugh's class was studying a series of clown stories. Instead of merely reading the stories or assigning them, she dressed as a clown to make the content "life-like" for the students.

Ms. Schappaugh completed her first year of teaching at Pine Grove June 6, having taught at Hahira Elementary since the 1979-80 school year. She also taught a year in the Berrien County school system, Perry said.

Partly Sunny

Georgia

● South Georgia should see partly sunny skies and hot temperatures with highs in the upper 90s. Winds should be out of the southwest at 10 mph. Tonight should be partly cloudy with lows in the middle-70s.



Farm & Future

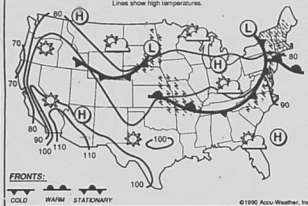
● Farmers should see widely scattered afternoon thunderstorms today, with amounts near a quarter-inch. Drying potential should be high with only 10 to 10 hours of sunshine.

● Georgia should see partly cloudy skies through Monday with highs in the upper 90s and lows in the mid-70s.

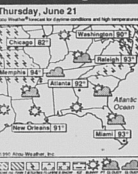
Rainfall For Month 5.16 inches
Rainfall For Year 17.65

The Nation

The Accu-Weather® forecast for noon, Thursday, June 21.



The Region



● The national forecast calls for thunderstorms in the eastern Dakotas and the south central states, as well as showers in the Northeast.

● Coastal Georgia should see partly cloudy skies with highs near 100 and lows in the middle 70s.

● Northwest Florida should see hazy skies with highs in the 90s and lows in the upper 70s.

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Woman Reports Being Abducted

A Valdosta woman reported being abducted in the 700 block of Old Lake Park Road Wednesday at 11:30 p.m., according to a Valdosta police report.

The woman said she was walking when a black male and black female forced her into a car, the report said. After the black woman got out, the male drove the other woman to Dasher-Johnson Road in the county before letting her go, the report said.

Man Arrested On Drug Charges

A Valdosta man is charged with possession of cocaine after being stopped by a Lowndes County Sheriff's Department officer at 12:15 a.m. Wednesday, according to a Lowndes-Valdosta Drug Unit report.

Police Beat

The police report stated that alleged sexual misconduct involving a younger boy was reported on Monday.

Juvenile authorities are pursuing the allegations under normal Juvenile Court procedures.

Lawnmower Taken From Saw Shop

A riding lawnmower was stolen from Goble's Saw Shop, 2111 Madison Highway, between 5:45 p.m. Tuesday and 8 a.m. Thursday, according to a Lowndes County Sheriff's Department report.

The lawnmower, a red Snapper model, with a white Tecumseh engine, was valued at \$1,800, the report said.

Juvenile Officials Pursue Allegation

Valdosta police have reported that a 14-year-old boy has been turned over to juvenile authorities after an alleged incident at the

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BEVERLY K. SCHAPPAUGH

Beverly Kay Schappaugh, 48, of Valdosta, died Sunday.

She was born in Roaring Springs, Penn., on Aug. 25, 1941, to John and Dorcas "Dee" Dexter. Ms. Schappaugh had lived in Lowndes County since 1973, was a fourth grade school teacher at Pine Grove Elementary School and was a volunteer worker for the Soup Kitchen.

She is survived by two sons, Paul Schappaugh of Valdosta and Mark Schappaugh of Atlanta; a daughter and son-in-law, Stephanie and Kenneth Marquis of Rota, Spain; her parents, John and Dorcas "Dee" Dexter of Crestview, Fla.; grandmother, Kathryn Helsel of Roaring Springs; and sisters, Johnna Smith of Chattanooga, Tenn., Elizabeth Williamson of Raleigh, N.C., and Karen Baker of Minneapolis, Minn.

Funeral services for Ms. Schappaugh will be held Friday at 4 p.m. in the chapel of the Carson McLane Funeral Home with Dr. Clyde Stokes, pastor of Greenwood Baptist Church, officiating. Interment will be at McLane's Riverview Memorial Gardens.

The family will be receiving friends at the funeral home from 7-9 p.m. on Thursday.

Carson McLane Funeral Home is serving the Schappaugh family.



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